

Appendix A: Glossary of Terms

- A -

acceleration lane – a lane that permits drivers entering a highway to accelerate to the speed of traffic

aggressive driving – the behavior of driving in a combative, forceful, or competitive manner

angle parking – the vehicle is parked diagonally to the curb

auto cycle – an autocycle constitutes a motor vehicle, other than a tractor, that is:

1. designed to have when propelled not more than three wheels on the ground
2. equipped with a steering wheel
3. equipped with seating that does not require the operator to straddle or sit astride the seat; and
4. manufactured and certified to comply with federal safety requirements for a motorcycle

An autocycle can be operated under a Class C driver license

- B -

backup lights – white lights at the rear of the vehicle telling other drivers you are backing up

basic speed law – you may not drive faster than is safe and prudent for existing conditions, regardless of posted speed limits

bicycle – every device propelled by human power upon which any person may ride, having two tandem wheels either of which is more than 14 inches in diameter

blind spot – an area rearview mirrors cannot show

blood-alcohol concentration (BAC) – the amount of alcohol in the blood expressed as a percentage of ethyl alcohol related to the volume of fluids in the bloodstream

blowout – the sudden loss of tire air pressure while driving

bodily-injury insurance – covers the driver who is at fault against claims

braking distance – the distance a vehicle travels from the time brakes are applied until it stops

- C -

cancellation – the withdrawal of a driver license or privilege until the driver is qualified or eligible

carbon monoxide – colorless, odorless, tasteless gas contained in the exhaust fumes of gasoline engines

center of gravity – point around which the vehicle's weight is evenly distributed

central vision – the field of vision around your focal vision in which you can see clearly while looking straight ahead that aids in determining vehicle position to the road

clutch pedal – the pedal in a manual transmission vehicle that enables a driver to shift gears

collision – contact between two or more objects, as when two vehicles collide into each other

collision insurance – provides insurance coverage to pay the costs of repair or replacement of your vehicle involved in a collision

color-blindness – inability to distinguish colors

commercial motor vehicle – a vehicle used to transport/deliver goods or passengers for compensation between points on a fixed scheduled route. The vehicle:

1. has a gross combination weight or gross combination weight rating of 26,001 or more pounds, including a towed unit with a gross vehicle weight or gross vehicle weight rating of more than 10,000 pounds;
2. has a gross vehicle weight or a gross vehicle weight rating of 26,001 or more pounds;
3. is designed to transport 16 or more passengers, including the driver or
4. is transporting hazardous materials and is required to be placarded under 49 C.F.R. part 172, Subpart F.

comprehensive insurance – provides coverage for replacement or repair of your vehicle from damage other than from a collision

controlled-access highway – a highway where vehicles can enter and exit only at interchanges

controlled braking – reducing speed by firmly stepping on and squeezing the brake pedal and maintaining steering control of the vehicle

controlled intersection – the intersection at which signals or signs determine the right of way

controlled railroad crossing – railroad crossing controlled by flashing red lights and/or crossing gates

crossbuck – large white X-shaped sign located prior to a railroad crossing